

printer and connect the power cable. You're good to go!

Printing Directly Off A Camera

Standards such as PictBridge now enable us to print photos directly off the camera using MFDs or photo-quality printers. You can simply connect the camera to the MFD using an USB cable, and in some cases wirelessly, and choose the photos you want



to print. The other standard that helps you do this is DPOF (Digital Print Order Format) which can be found on many cameras today. It lets you tag the photos you want to print. That way you don't have to dump photos onto a computer and then send print orders for a select few.

Access Control

Over time, you'll discover a lot of paper and toner is wasted over unnecessary prints. To avoid such waste, you can allot access to only a few members of your office. To do this, in the Control Panel, click Printers and Faxes. Right-click on your MFD's icon and click Properties. Click on the Security tab, and you'll find options similar to those in Windows file sharing. You can choose what tasks you would like to allow users to perform. Click on Apply and then on OK.

Avoid Paper Jams

One of the biggest issues with any type of printing is the paper jams. Papers

can get stuck in the printer due to several reasons. Haphazard loading of paper can cause curling up of paper—one of the main causes of paper jams. The other reason is humidity. Stagnant paper can become humid and jam the printer. So when the printer is not in use for long periods, remove the paper from the tray and store it in a dry place. When getting a new batch of paper, remove it from the packaging and leave it in the same room as the printer a day or two in advance.

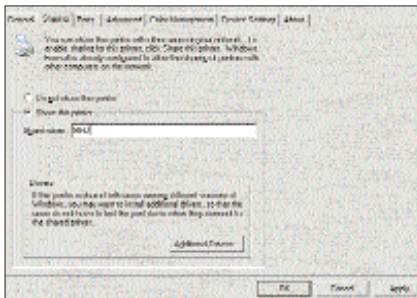
While removing jammed paper from laser printers or MFDs, make sure you don't forcefully pull the paper—you could cause damage to the rollers or the fuser. The proper way would be to roll the rollers to ease the paper out.

Print Previews

Many a time, when we are about to send the print command, we have no clue about how many pages will be printed. In applications that do not display how many pages are to be printed, the best way to find out is to use Print Preview (File > Print Preview).

Sharing Your MFD

Like printers, MFDs can be shared over a network. To do this, you first need to enable File and Print Sharing for your network adapter. In the Control Panel, click on Printers and Faxes. Right-click on the MFD / printer and click Properties. Click on the Sharing tab and give a name for the printer. Clicking on the list in the directory will make the printer public in the Active Directory.



Let everyone on the network have access to your printer

Cancel Unwanted Prints

We sometimes give prints by mistake, or we later realise that the number of pages to be printed is way too many. The proper way to cancel the printing is to double-click on the printer icon in the System Tray when a print command has been sent. Select the prints you want to cancel, right-click on them, and click Cancel.

Calibrating Your MFD

Monitors create colours by combining RGB (Red, Green, and Blue), whereas printers work by CMYK (Cyan, Magenta, Yellow, and Black—Key). When an image we see on our screens is printed, it doesn't quite turn out exactly as expected. Calibration of the both the monitor and printer is required for the best matching results. Perfectionists would use hardware devices to calibrate the monitor and the printer, but pretty good results can be had just by careful observations. Start by calibrating the monitor using software such as DisplayMate, or Web sites that offer similar tests that help achieve the optimum settings for the monitor. You are required to follow steps such as reducing the brightness and contrast and then gradually increasing them until certain features of the image on screen are displayed.

When you're done with the monitor, load up a high-quality test print image available on printer calibration sites. These images are uncompressed and contain all sorts of colours and gradients—which will help you achieve the best settings for the printer. Take a test printout. Having known that the monitor is tuned properly, compare and observe the printout with the display to find any abnormalities. Then, under Printers and Faxes in the Control Panel, right-click on your MFD's icon and click Properties. Navigate to your colour settings. Make alterations to the colours so as to get it closer to the colours you see on the screen. Take printouts to check the differences every time you tinker with the settings. Make sure you remember them for future reference! ☑

rossi_fernandes@thinkdigit.com

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